

Intuition Engine Architecture

Last modified: 2026-06-05

Intuition Engine is a multi-CPU fantasy computer with 6 heterogeneous CPU cores, 6 video systems, audio engines and players, a copper coprocessor, DMA blitter, and extensive I/O peripherals - all connected through a unified MachineBus. Total guest RAM is sized at boot from platform-dispatched usable-RAM detection (`/proc/meminfo` on Linux, `GlobalMemoryStatusEx` on Windows, and `hw.memsize` on Darwin) minus a per-platform reserve. Darwin RAM sizing uses a page-aligned conservative half of `hw.memsize` as the detected base before applying the per-platform reserve. Each CPU/profile sees an active visible RAM clamped to its own ceiling. Guest software discovers sizes through the `SYSINFO MMIO` pairs (`SYSINFO_TOTAL_RAM_L0/HI`, `SYSINFO_ACTIVE_RAM_L0/HI`) and `IE64 CR_RAM_SIZE_BYTES`. This document describes the system architecture with diagrams showing chips, buses, internal functional units, and data flow paths.

The diagrams below describe wired runtime behaviour. Platform availability follows the runtime dispatch path; for example, the Z80 JIT is available on amd64 builds only.

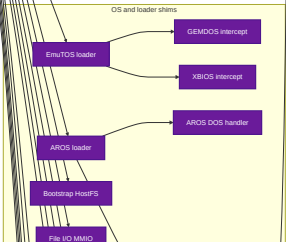
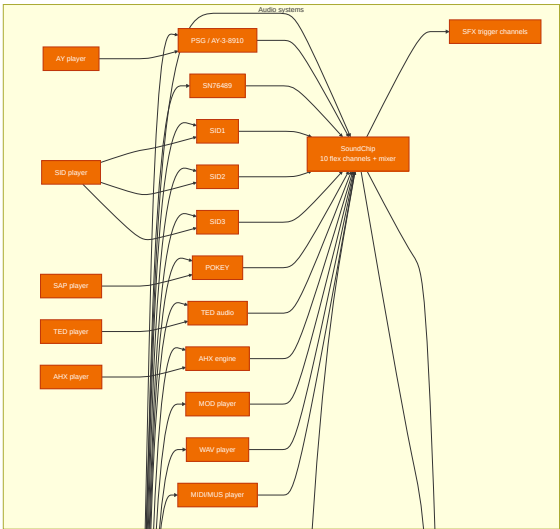
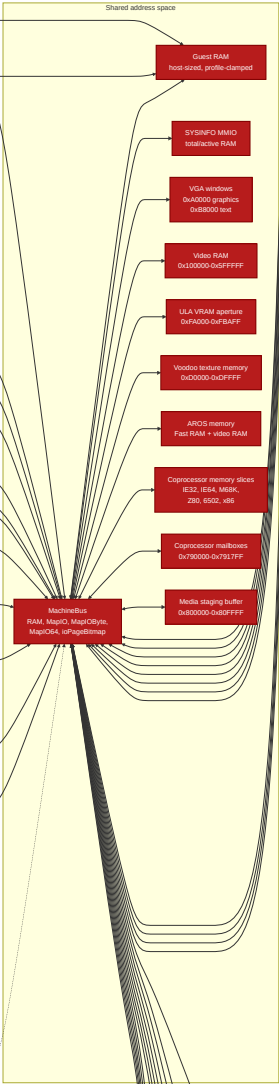
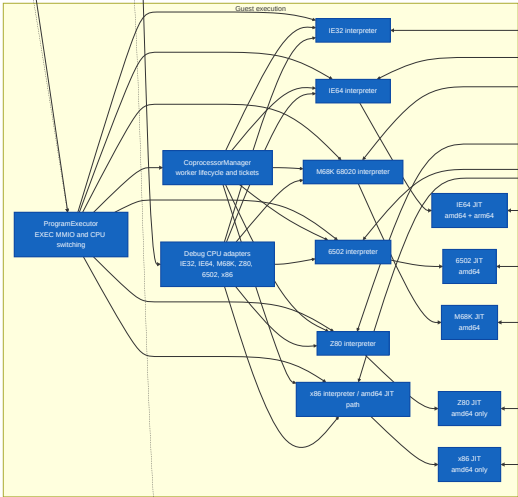
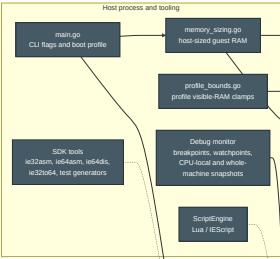
Reading the Architecture Tables and Diagrams

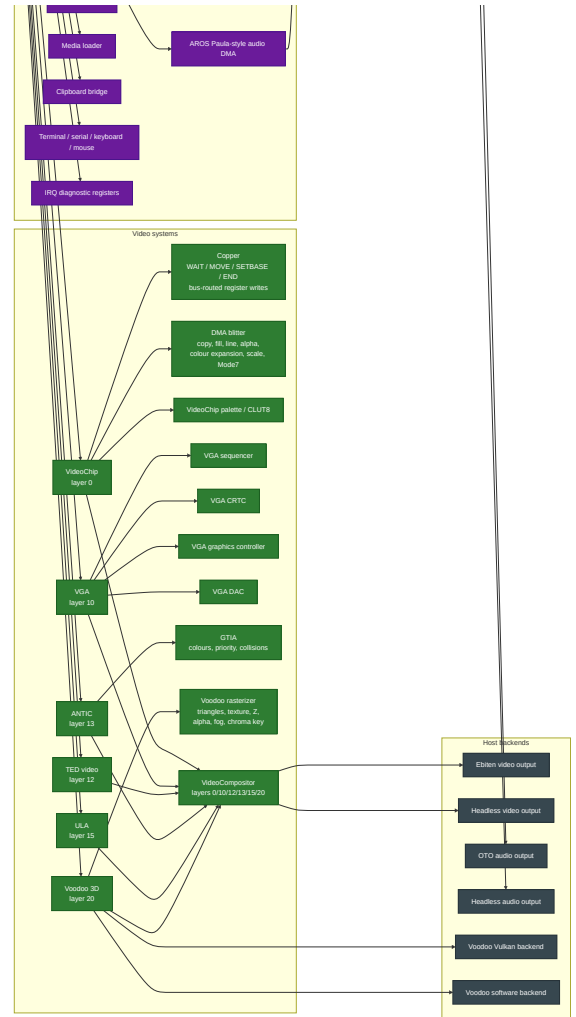
Boxes represent runtime components. Arrows represent operational paths: direct calls, bus mappings, shared-memory paths, queues, or host-service dependencies. Memory-map rows describe guest-visible address ranges and the device or subsystem that owns each range.

Diagram/table item	Meaning
Address range	Guest-visible range plus decoded mapping, owner, and reservation/use semantics
Visible RAM size	RAM visible to the current CPU/profile, as reported by <code>SYSINFO</code> and CPU-specific discovery paths
CPU or JIT entry	CPU core or JIT backend available through the runtime dispatch path
Audio, video, or peripheral box	Engine, player, device, or bridge that participates in the running machine
Debugger or scripting path	Monitor, debug adapter, or Lua binding path used for inspection or automation

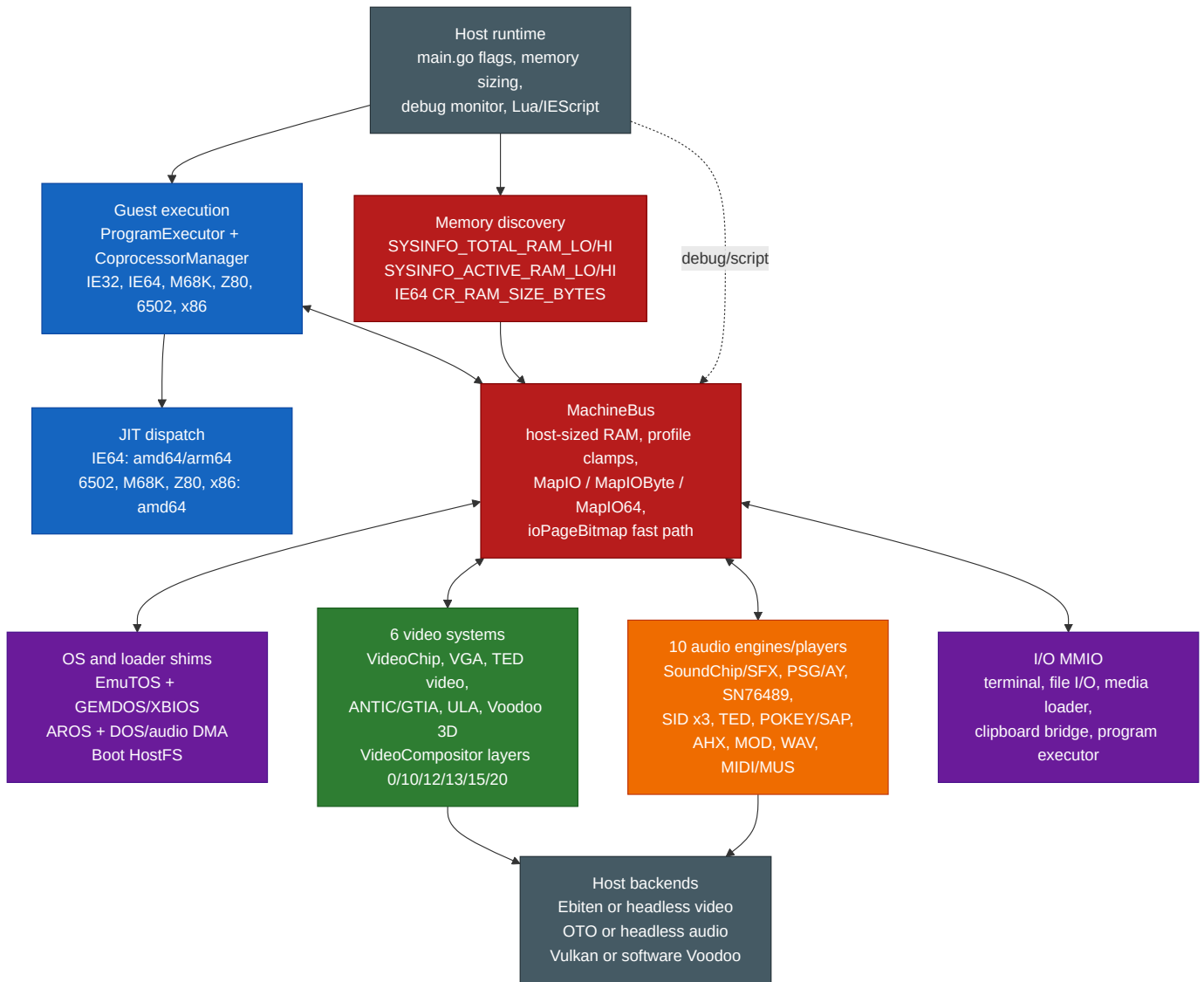
If a feature is platform-limited, the table or diagram names the supported platform path instead of implying that every implementation file is active in every build.

Single Complete Architecture Diagram

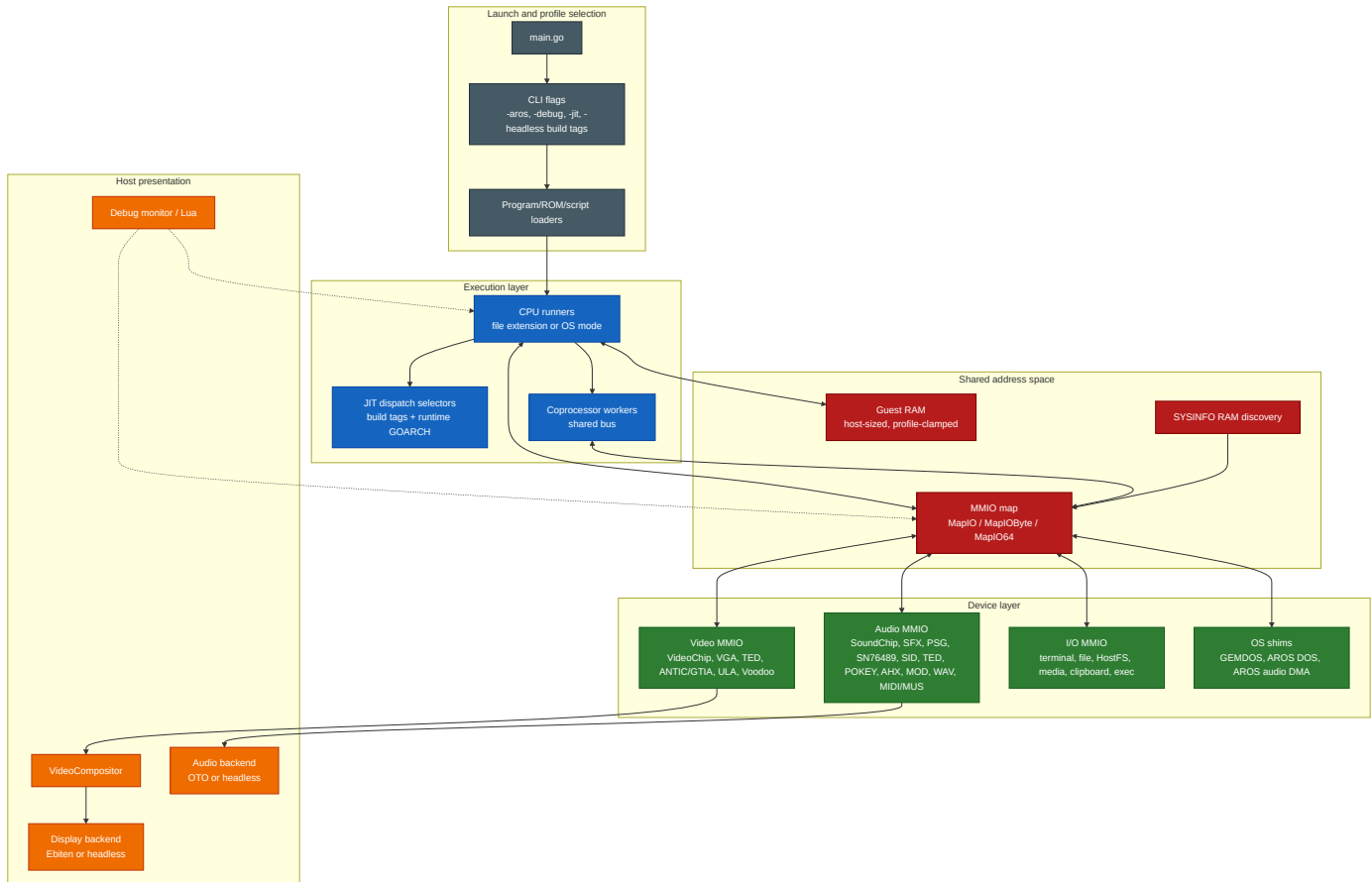




1. Whole-System Architecture



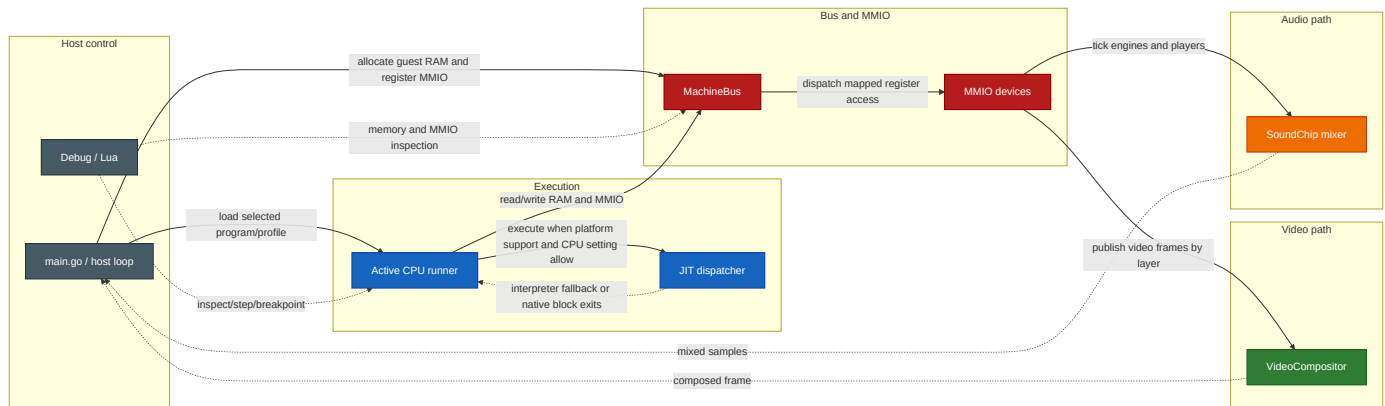
2. Layered System Overview



Bus architecture notes:

- **Concurrent multi-CPU bus** - the Program Executor selects the primary CPU mode, but the Coprocessor Manager can launch additional worker CPUs that run concurrently on the same bus. Address dispatch is immutable after mapping is sealed, `ioPageBitmap` provides the fast path, and I/O callbacks protect their own mutable state. There is no central bus-arbitration model exposed to guest software.
- **No centralised interrupt controller** - each CPU has per-CPU interrupt lines (`IRQ/NMI` as `atomic.Bool`). Peripherals signal the active CPU directly.
- **MMIO dispatch** - the bus uses an `ioPageBitmap []bool` fast path (page = 256 bytes). Non-I/O pages use direct unsafe pointer access with zero dispatch overhead.

Runtime Data and Control Flow



Subsystem Matrix

Subsystem	Runtime surface	Primary files	Wired registration / dispatch
CPU cores	IE32, IE64, M68K, Z80, 6502, x86	cpu_*.go, cpu_*_runner.go	main.go selects runners by file extension, OS mode, or EXEC MMIO
JIT	IE64 on amd64/arm64; 6502, M68K, Z80, x86 on amd64	jit_dispatch.go, jit_6502_dispatch.go, jit_m68k_dispatch.go, jit_z80_dispatch.go, jit_x86_dispatch.go	Build tags plus runtime.GOARCH; non-supported hosts use dispatch stubs
Bus and RAM	Host-sized guest RAM, profile clamps, MMIO, byte/64-bit handlers	machine_bus.go, memory_sizing.go, profile_bounds.go, sysinfo_mmio.go	main.go registers devices before execution; MachineBus.SealMappings prevents late maps
Video	VideoChip, VGA, TED video, ANTIC/GTIA, ULA, Voodoo	video_chip.go, video_vga.go, video_ted.go, video_antic.go, video_ula.go, video_voodoo.go	main.go maps each register/VRAM block and registers compositor layers 0/10/12/13/15/20
Audio	SoundChip/SFX, PSG/AY, SN76489, SID x3, TED, POKEY/SAP, AHX, MOD, WAV, MIDI/MUS	audio_chip.go, sfx_trigger.go, psg_engine.go, sn76489_chip.go, sid_engine.go, ted_engine.go, pokey_engine.go, ahx_player.go, mod_player.go, wav_player.go, midi_player.go	main.go maps chip/player MMIO and registers sample tickers/mixers into SoundChip
OS integration	EmuTOS, AROS, GEMDOS/XBIOS, AROS DOS, Paula-style DMA	emutos_loader.go, aros_loader.go, gemdos_intercept.go, aros_dos_intercept.go, aros_audio_dma.go	OS modes install intercept MMIO and loader state during boot/reset
Tooling	Assemblers, disassembler, transpiler, generators	assembler/, cmd/ie32to64/, cmd/gen_m68k_cputest/, cmd/gen_interp6502/	Makefile builds SDK tools into sdk/bin/

Platform JIT Matrix

The host-side JIT support is intentionally asymmetric and follows the dispatch files, not emitter-file presence. Release amd64 builds target x86-64-v3 (GOAMD64=v3, the Makefile default) for the best Go-compiler codegen (AVX2, BMI1/2, FMA), but this is a recommendation, not a hard requirement: the JIT only *requires* SSE4.1, which it emits unconditionally for IE64 FINT (ROUNDSS). The amd64 backend detects this at runtime via CPUID; on a host without SSE4.1 `initJIT` (via `checkJITHostFeatures`) declines to enable the JIT and the CPU falls back to the interpreter rather than aborting, so plain `go run . / go build` at the default `GOAMD64=v1` works on any x86-64 CPU (older hosts simply run interpreted). AVX2/BMI2/LZCNT paths are separately runtime-gated via `x86Host` and are never emitted unless the host supports them.

Host platform	JIT-enabled guest cores	Dispatch files
Linux amd64	IE64, 6502, M68K, Z80, x86	<code>jit_dispatch.go</code> , amd64 per-core dispatch files
Linux arm64	IE64	<code>jit_dispatch.go</code> ; Z80 dispatch compiles but keeps <code>z80JitAvailable</code> false
Windows amd64	IE64, 6502, M68K, Z80, x86	amd64 per-core dispatch files
Windows arm64	IE64	IE64 dispatch only; per-core non-IE64 stubs
macOS amd64	IE64, 6502, M68K, Z80, x86	amd64 per-core dispatch files
macOS arm64	IE64	IE64 dispatch plus Darwin arm64 JIT write-protect helpers

On macOS amd64, the JIT reuses the shared x86-64 host backends. On macOS arm64, executable memory uses the native `MAP_JIT` model with thread-pinned write protection toggles, and non-IE64 guest cores remain interpreter-only on arm64 hosts.

IE64 JIT 64-bit Execution Model

The IE64 JIT (amd64 and arm64) executes code, accesses data, and operates the stack at any `uint64` virtual or physical address, matching the interpreter. There is no `uint32` truncation on the PC, data addresses, stack pointer, branch targets, or chain targets. The one stack exception is the amd64 non-MMU fused-leaf path (documented below): it raw-indexes `[MemBase+SP]` and so assumes the SP is in the low window.

SEI64 and CLI64 are emitted as per-instruction interpreter bails (not NOPs) so they mutate `interruptEnabled` under the JIT. External device interrupts are delivered through a record-only sink and a pending mask polled at instruction and block boundaries by both the interpreter and the JIT dispatcher; see the "External Interrupt Delivery" section of this manual for the full model.

- **Low memory window:** each guest sees a contiguous low RAM window backed by the dense `cpu.memory[]` slice, capped at 256 MiB for the IE64 family (`lowMemWindowBytes`). The actual `len(bus.memory)` is `min(autodetectedTotalGuestRAM, busMemCap)` (`main.go`), so on a small host the window can be smaller than the cap. Addresses above the window resolve through the bus's 64-bit physical path, backed by the `Backing` interface -- production IE64 boots on Linux/darwin bind high RAM via `MmapBacking`; `SparseBacking` is the test implementation. High physical addresses are supported for code fetch and for data / stack *operands* (the latter via the helper exit, including a high SP), with one caveat below.
- **High-PC stack-op caveat:** a block *fetches* from high physical backing that itself contains a stack op (`PUSH/POP/JSR/RTS/JSR_IND`) is not JIT-compiled -- `ExecuteJIT` takes the `highPhys && containsStackOp(instrs)` path and runs the block one instruction at a time through `interpretOne()` (which routes the stack through the bus). This is pinned by `TestJIT_HighPC_StackOpBlock_BailsToInterpreter`. Stack ops in blocks fetched from the low window are JIT-compiled and, for a high SP, route through the helper exit -- **except** the fused-leaf path below.

- **Fused-leaf high-SP exception:** on amd64 with the MMU off, scanBlock may fuse a JSR64 to a small leaf subroutine (ie64FusedJSRLeafCall / ie64FusedRTSLeafReturn, gated by ie64ScanJSRLeafFusionEnabled -- amd64 only). The fused emit (jit_emit_amd64.go) handles the call/return push/pop as **raw** [MemBase+SP] traffic *before* the normal emitJSR_AMD64/emitRTS_AMD64 high-SP guards, so it does **not** take the helper exit. This is safe only because the marker is suppressed whenever mmuBail is set, but mmuBail for fused leaves is set by compileBlockMMU (MMU mode) only -- in non-MMU mode a fused leaf with an SP outside the low window would read/write past cpu.memory[]. Non-MMU guests are therefore expected to keep the stack in the low window; high-SP correctness via the helper exit holds for unfused stack ops, not for fused leaves.
- **Direct fast path vs. helper exit:** native code uses a direct [memBase+addr] access only when the MMU is off **and** the address is in the low window (size-aware bound: addr <= MemSize - accessBytes). Otherwise it takes the JITContext-mediated *helper exit*.
- **Helper exit protocol:** native code cannot safely call back into Go (it runs on g0 via asmcgocall), so on a high/MMU access it writes a structured request to the JITContext (NeedHelper, HelperAddr, HelperSize, HelperVal, HelperRd, HelperPC, LiveSP), flushes the live SP and the faulting instruction's PC, and returns through the epilogue. ExecuteJIT dispatches the request (handleJITHelper) and re-enters the JIT. Helper ops cover LOAD/STORE, FLOAD/FSTORE, DLOAD/DSTORE, PUSH/POP, and the control-flow JSR/RTS/JSR_IND.
- **Interpreter parity:** helpers use cpu.loadMem/storeMem for data and cpu.mmuStackWrite/mmuStackRead for the stack -- the same paths as the interpreter. JSR sets PC to the call target, RTS sets PC to the popped return address, and JSR_IND sets PC to rs + sext(imm32) -- the displacement is sign-extended, so a negative imm32 (bit 31 set) subtracts (with rs == R31 based on the decremented SP). The FP load/store side effects differ: FLOAD and DLOAD set the destination FP register **and** the FP condition codes; FSTORE and DSTORE read the FP register and write memory, leaving FP registers and condition codes unchanged -- matching the interpreter in each case.
- **MMU rule:** when the MMU is enabled, non-atomic data/stack ops take the helper exit (virtual-to-physical mapping is not a direct offset). The dispatcher refreshes ctx.MMUEnabled before every callNative so the native guards are never stale.
- **Fault contract:** the handler sets cpu.PC = HelperPC before the operation, so trapFault records the correct faultPC; faulting instructions are not counted and re-execute after the trap. Pre-decrement ops (PUSH/JSR/JSR_IND) roll the SP back on a trapping fault.
- **Atomics carve-out:** atomics (CAS/XCHG/FAA/FAND/FOR/FXOR) do not use the helper-exit protocol. The native emitters run sequentially-consistent host-atomic fast paths only for aligned, non-MMU, low-window RAM addresses; MMU-on, high-address, MMIO, or unaligned cases bail to the interpreter so the canonical atomicRMW64 trap and bus semantics apply. compileBlockMMU also sets mmuBail on fused JSR/RTS leaf markers, so under MMU the OP_JS64/ OP_RTS64 emit takes the mmuBail branch to emitBailToInterpreter (a whole-instruction interpreter bail with its own fault/accounting path) -- neither the raw fused fast path nor the guarded helper exit runs. In non-MMU mode mmuBail is unset, so the raw fused fast path is used (see the fused-leaf high-SP exception above).

Build Profiles and Observable Runtime

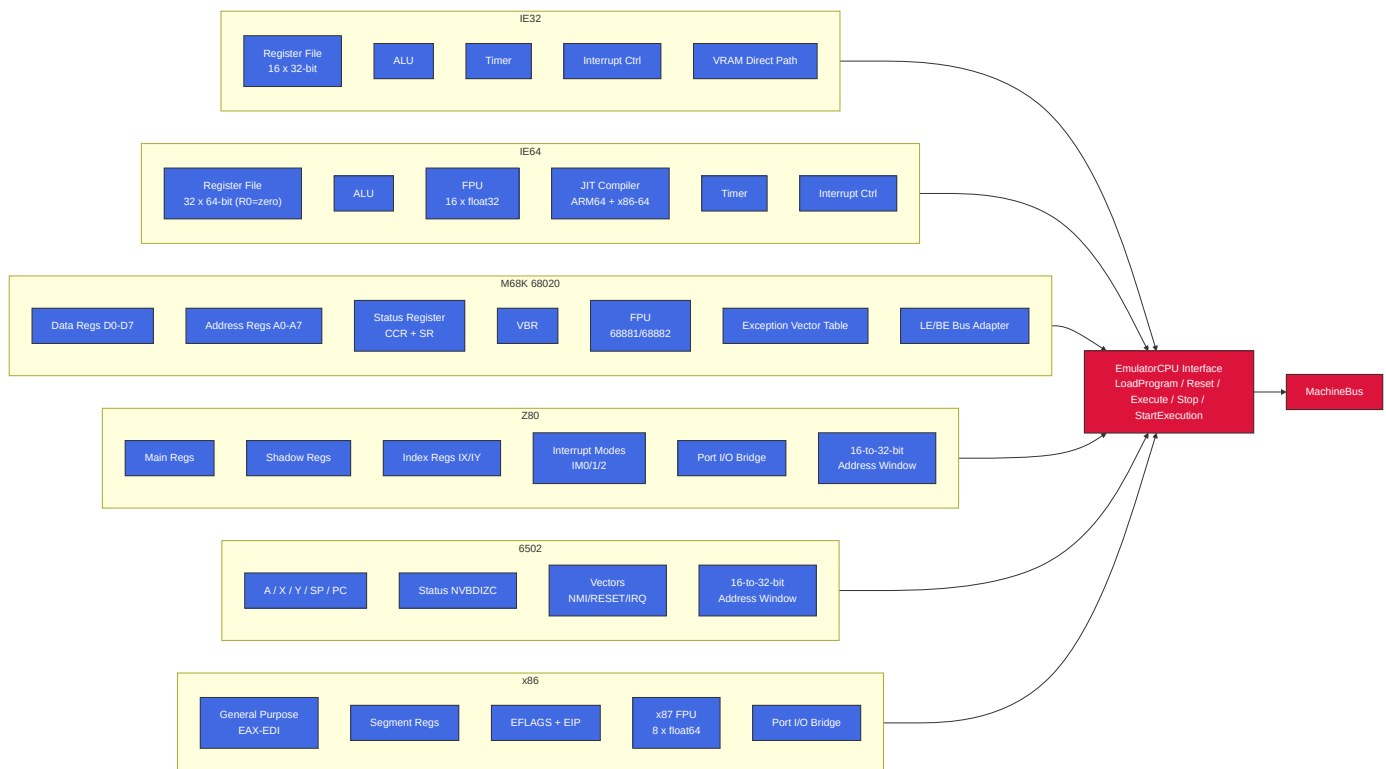
Build tags change host backends, not the guest-visible ISA contract. The main guest bus, CPU cores, MMIO register addresses, assemblers, and script binding names remain the reference surface unless a specific backend is absent from the build. On amd64, release profiles target x86-64-v3 for codegen quality; lower GOAMD64 levels still build and run, with SSE4.1 as the enforced runtime floor.

Profile	Build tags / knobs	Runtime effect visible to users
Default VM	no special tag	Ebiten display, Oto audio, Vulkan-backed Voodoo where available, and normal host integrations.

Profile	Build tags / knobs	Runtime effect visible to users
novulkan	-tags novulkan	Voodoo uses the software backend and does not require the Vulkan SDK. Guest Voodoo registers remain mapped.
headless	-tags headless	Display, audio backend, overlay, clipboard, and GUI integrations use stubs suitable for CI. CPU, bus, MMIO, scripting, and most device state paths still compile for tests.
headless-novulkan	CGO_ENABLED=0 -tags "novulkan headless"	Pure-Go portable VM build with headless stubs and software Voodoo path.

Headless stubs should be treated as backend substitutes, not as a different machine model. A test can still write video or audio MMIO and inspect guest state, but there is no host window, host audio device, or GUI overlay to observe the result directly.

3. CPU Subsystem



CPU Timers (IE32 / IE64)

Both IE32 and IE64 use CPU-internal countdown timers backed by atomic fields on the CPU structs.

- IE32 increments an internal cycle counter once per decoded instruction step, after fetch and operand resolution and before the decoded instruction body executes; when that counter reaches `SAMPLE_RATE`, it resets the counter and decrements the timer count by one.
- IE64 decrements the timer count once per decoded instruction step, after fetch/decode and before the decoded instruction body executes. When the IE64 timer is armed, JIT dispatch uses the CPU single-instruction path so an interrupt can be delivered before the body of the instruction whose decoded step expires the timer.
- On expiry, it sets timer state to expired and can trigger a CPU interrupt.
- If still enabled after interrupt handling, the count auto-reloads from the configured period.

There is no stable bus/MMIO timer control ABI at present. Legacy include symbols such as TIMER_CTRL/TIMER_COUNT/TIMER_RELOAD are retained for compatibility but are deprecated.

CPU Selection by File Extension

Extension	CPU	Address Space	Notes
.iex / .ie32	IE32	32-bit flat (clamped to active visible RAM)	Native RISC, 8-byte fixed instructions
.ie64	IE64	64-bit (sees full active visible RAM)	64-bit RISC, R0=zero, JIT on ARM64 + x86-64
.ie68	M68K	32-bit flat (clamped to active visible RAM)	Bare 68020, big-endian with LE bus adapter
.ie65	6502	16-bit + bank windows	Bank windows reach the banked-CPU visible ceiling
.ie80	Z80	16-bit + bank windows + port I/O bridge	Bank windows reach the banked-CPU visible ceiling
.ie86	x86	32-bit flat (clamped to active visible RAM) + compatibility bank windows	Ordinary addressing is flat; bank/VRAM windows are compatibility overlays
.tos / .img	M68K	EmuTOS profile (EmuTOS_PROFILE_TOP)	EmuTOS boot with GEMDOS intercept
.ies	Script	N/A	Lua scripting engine (IE Script)

Bare .ie68 uses the active-visible RAM ceiling; EmuTOS and AROS M68K loader modes use profile bounds.

AROS boot is selected by CLI mode (-aros, optional -aros-image), not file extension.

Z80 Port I/O Bridge

Z80 IN/OUT instructions are translated to bus MMIO accesses by the Z80BusAdapter:

Z80 Port	Chip	Bus Target	Protocol
\$A0-\$AD	VGA	0xF1000	Direct register map (MODE, STATUS, CTRL, SEQ, CRTIC, GC, DAC, DAC read index, DAC mask, VRAM bank)
\$B0-\$B7	Voodoo 3D	0xF8000	Addr lo/hi + 4 data bytes (write to \$B5 triggers 32-bit bus write)
\$D0/\$D1	POKEY	0xF0D00	Register select / data
\$D4/\$D5	ANTIC	0xF2100	Register select / data (x4 stride)
\$D6/\$D7	GTIA	0xF2140	Register select / data (x4 stride, collision regs through 0xF21F8)
\$E0/\$E1	SID	0xF0E00/0xF0E30/0xF0E50	Register select / data; select bits 5-6 choose SID1/SID2/SID3
\$E4/\$E5	SN76489	0xF0C30/0xF0C31	Data write / last-written read and ready-status read
\$F0/\$F1	PSG	0xF0C00	Register select / data
\$F2/\$F3	TED	0xF0F00 / 0xF0F20 - 0xF0F6B	Register select / data (audio indices \$00-\$05, video indices \$20-\$32 x4 stride)
\$FE/\$FD/\$BE/\$FA/\$FB/\$FC	ULA	0xF2000-0xF2014	Border, control, status, VRAM address latch low/high, and paged VRAM data

Z80 16-bit Memory Translation

Z80 memory accesses in 0xF000-0xFFFF are translated to bus 0xF0000-0xF0FFF. ANTIC/GTIA access is provided through the Z80 port bridge (\$D4-\$D7) rather than general memory-mapped addressing.

x86 Port I/O Bridge

x86 shares the Z80 Voodoo port mapping (\$B0-\$B7) and most sound-chip port mappings, but **POKEY uses direct port-to-register mapping** (not the Z80's select/data protocol). x86 does not implement standard PC VGA I/O ports; VGA access is through the shared bus MMIO aperture and the direct \$A0000-\$AFFFF VRAM memory window.

x86 Port	Chip	Bus Target	Protocol
\$B0-\$B7	Voodoo 3D	0xF8000	Addr lo/hi + 4 data bytes
\$60-\$69	POKEY	0xF0D00+(port-0x60)	Direct - port offset maps to writable register
\$D4/\$D5	ANTIC	0xF2100	Register select / data (x4 stride)
\$D6/\$D7	GTIA	0xF2140	Register select / data (x4 stride, collision regs through 0xF21F8)
\$E0/\$E1	SID	0xF0E00/0xF0E30/0xF0E50	Register select / data; select bits 5-6 choose SID1/SID2/SID3
\$F0/\$F1	PSG	0xF0C00	Register select / data
\$F2/\$F3	TED	0xF0F00 / 0xF0F20 - 0xF0F6B	Register select / data (audio indices \$00-\$05, video indices \$20-\$32 x4 stride)
\$FE	ULA	0xF2000	Border colour only (bits 0-2)

Key difference from Z80: x86 POKEY access is direct - ports \$60-\$69 map one-to-one onto writable POKEY registers at 0xF0D00+(port-0x60). ANTIC (\$D4/\$D5) and GTIA (\$D6/\$D7) keep their own select/data pairs.

x86 also directly accesses VGA VRAM at \$A0000-\$AFFFF in the memory path (no port translation needed).

Bank Windows (Z80 / 6502 / x86)

The banked 6502/Z80 ABI uses bank windows to access a 32 MiB banked-CPU visible ceiling from a 16-bit address space; bank translation rejects addresses at or above that ceiling. x86 ordinary addressing remains flat 32-bit, but the x86 bus adapter also implements the same compatibility bank windows plus a VRAM bank window. Those x86 window translations are capped at the legacy DEFAULT_MEMORY_SIZE ceiling; ordinary x86 addressing remains clamped by the active visible RAM exposed through the shared bus.

CPU Address	Size	Purpose	Bank Select Register
\$2000-\$3FFF	8KB	Bank 1 (sprite data)	\$F700/\$F701 (lo/hi)
\$4000-\$5FFF	8KB	Bank 2 (font data)	\$F702/\$F703 (lo/hi)
\$6000-\$7FFF	8KB	Bank 3 (general)	\$F704/\$F705 (lo/hi)
\$8000-\$BFFF	16KB	VRAM window	\$F7F0 (bank number)
\$F000-\$FFF9	4090B	I/O window, excluding 6502 vectors	Hardwired: \$Fxxx -> bus \$F0xxx
\$F200-\$F24F	80B	Coprocessor gateway subrange	Hardwired: -> bus \$F2340+offset
\$FFFA-\$FFFF	6B	6502 vectors (NMI/RESET/IRQ)	Identity mapped

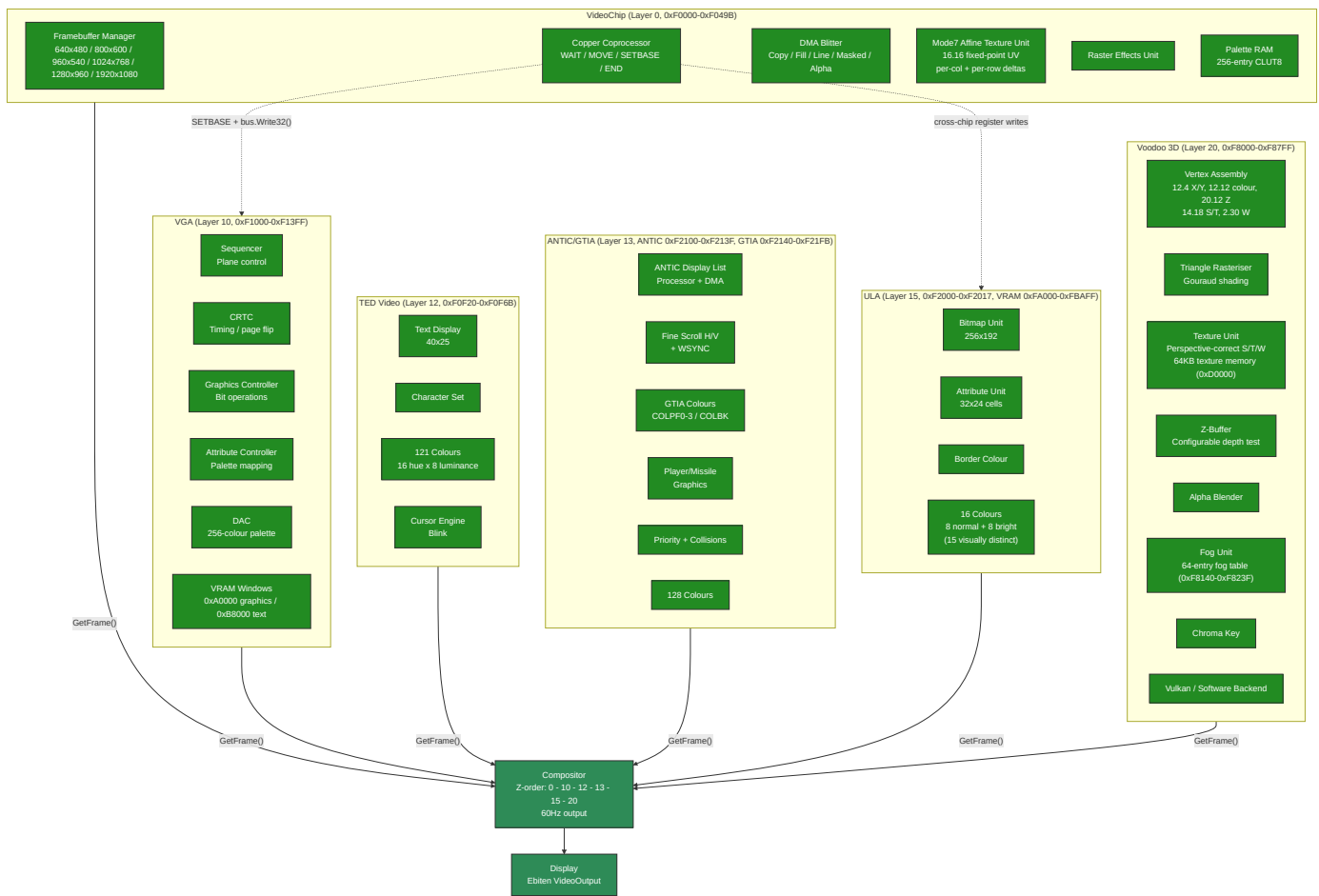
6502 I/O Chip Page Dispatch

The 6502 uses ioTable[page] to route memory-mapped I/O through the bus:

6502 Address	Chip	Bus Target	Notes
\$D200-\$D209	POKEY	0xF0D00+offset	
\$D400-\$D40F	PSG	0xF0C00+offset	
\$D500-\$D51F	SID1	0xF0E00+offset	32-byte window
\$D520-\$D53F	SID2	0xF0E30+offset	32-byte window
\$D540-\$D55F	SID3	0xF0E50+offset	32-byte window
\$D600-\$D605	TED Audio	0xF0F00+offset	
\$D620-\$D632	TED Video	0xF0F20+offset x4	Stride-4 register mapping including raster compare registers
\$D700-\$D70D	VGA	0xF1000	Direct handler call plus DAC read index, DAC mask, and VRAM bank
\$D800-\$D817	ULA	0xF2000+offset	Registers plus paged VRAM data port

ANTIC/GTIA intentionally has no 6502 \$D400/\$D000 compatibility surface; \$D400-\$D40F is PSG on the 6502 map.

4. Video Subsystem



Copper Cross-Chip Bus Access

The copper coprocessor is internal to VideoChip but can write to any MMIO-mapped chip on the bus:

- **Default:** MOVE targets VideoChip's own registers (`copperIOBase = VIDEO_REG_BASE`)
- **SETBASE opcode** changes `copperIOBase` to any MMIO address (e.g. `VGA_BASE 0xF1000`)
- Subsequent MOVE instructions compute `regAddr = copperIOBase + (regIndex * 4)` and route via `bus.Write32()` to VGA, ULA, or any other chip's MMIO
- This enables per-scanline palette changes, mode switches, and register manipulation on any video chip
- `copperIOBase` resets to `VIDEO_REG_BASE` at the start of each frame
- The compositor's `ScanlineAware` interface orchestrates this: `StartFrame() -> ProcessScanline(y) -> FinishFrame()`

Extended Blitter: BPP Modes, Draw Modes, Colour Expansion, and Scale

The blitter supports two pixel formats via `BLT_FLAGS` (`0xF0488`): `RGBA32` (4 bpp, default) and `CLUT8` (1 bpp). Bits 4-7 select one of 16 raster draw modes (Clear, And, Copy, Xor, Invert, etc.) applied per pixel during FILL and COPY operations. `BLT_OP=4` performs source-over alpha blending with source alpha in bits 31-24 using `out = (src*a + dst*(255-a))/255`. `BLT_OP=7` performs nearest-neighbour scaling in `RGBA32` or `CLUT8`. When `BLT_FLAGS=0`, the blitter defaults to Copy mode with `RGBA32` for full backward compatibility.

`BLT_CTRL` bit 0 starts the synchronous blit, bit 1 is read-only busy, and bit 2 enables a completion pulse on `IntMaskBlitter`. `BLT_STATUS` bit 0 is ERR, bit 1 is DONE, and bit 2 is sticky `IRQ_PENDING` (write 1 to clear). Invalid opcodes, out-of-range Mode7 samples, and overflowed blitter bounds set ERR and do not silently fall back to COPY.

The colour expansion operation (`BLT_OP=6`) renders 1-bit glyph templates into coloured pixels for hardware-accelerated text. It reads a template from `BLT_MASK`, uses `BLT_FG/BLT_BG` (`0xF048C/0xF0490`) as foreground/background colours, and supports three modes: JAM2 (opaque - set bits write FG, clear bits write BG), JAM1 (transparent - only set bits write FG), and Invert (set bits XOR the destination). `BLT_MASK_MOD` (`0xF0494`) sets the template row stride and `BLT_MASK_SRCX` (`0xF0498`) provides sub-byte bit alignment for glyph fragments. Template bits are MSB-first (Amiga convention).

Line drawing (`BLT_OP=2`) supports an extended mode when `BLT_FLAGS != 0`: `BLT_DST` becomes the framebuffer base address, `BLT_WIDTH` holds the packed endpoint coordinates $(y1 < 16) \times x1$, and `BLT_DST_STRIDE` sets the row stride. This allows line drawing into arbitrary bitmaps (not just the active framebuffer) with BPP awareness and all 16 draw modes. When `BLT_FLAGS=0`, legacy behaviour is preserved (endpoint in `BLT_DST`, base at `VRAM_START`). In extended mode the blitter does not clip - callers must provide pre-clipped coordinates (the AROS driver uses Cohen-Sutherland clipping before calling the blitter).

Scale blits (`BLT_OP=7`) use `BLT_SRC/BLT_DST` as base addresses, `BLT_WIDTH/BLT_HEIGHT` as the source size in pixels, and `BLT_COLOR` as a packed destination size ($\text{height} \ll 16 \mid \text{width}$). `BLT_SRC_STRIDE` defaults to source width times bytes-per-pixel. `BLT_DST_STRIDE` defaults to the active VideoChip mode stride for VRAM destinations or destination width times bytes-per-pixel for ordinary memory. In non-direct VRAM mode, visible VRAM accesses use the active VideoChip front buffer and off-screen VRAM aperture accesses fall back to bus memory so back buffers can be presented through `VIDEO_FB_BASE`. Out-of-bounds source or destination rectangles, rectangles crossing the VRAM aperture end, zero source dimensions, and zero destination dimensions set `BLT_STATUS.ERR`.

Raster-band register draws (`VIDEO_RASTER_Y`, `VIDEO_RASTER_HEIGHT`, `VIDEO_RASTER_COLOR`, `VIDEO_RASTER_CTRL`) target the active framebuffer source. In `RGBA32` mode, a nonzero `VIDEO_FB_BASE` writes the band into bus memory at that base; otherwise it writes the internal front buffer or direct VRAM slice. In `CLUT8` mode, raster bands write indexed bytes at `VIDEO_FB_BASE`.

Register	Address	Description
BLT_FLAGS	0xF0488	BPP (bits 0-1), draw mode (bits 4-7), JAM1/invert flags (bits 8-10)
BLT_FG	0xF048C	Foreground colour for colour expansion
BLT_BG	0xF0490	Background colour for colour expansion
BLT_MASK_MOD	0xF0494	Template row modulo (bytes per row)
BLT_MASK_SRCX	0xF0498	Starting X bit offset in template

Mode7 Affine Texture Unit

The blitter's Mode7 operation (`blt0pMode7`) implements SNES-style affine texture mapping as a DMA blitter mode within VideoChip. It uses 8 dedicated MMIO registers (0xF0058-0xF0074):

Register	Address	Description
BLT_MODE7_U0	0xF0058	Starting U coordinate (16.16 fixed-point)
BLT_MODE7_V0	0xF005C	Starting V coordinate (16.16 fixed-point)
BLT_MODE7_DU_COL	0xF0060	U increment per column (16.16)
BLT_MODE7_DV_COL	0xF0064	V increment per column (16.16)
BLT_MODE7_DU_ROW	0xF0068	U increment per row (16.16)
BLT_MODE7_DV_ROW	0xF006C	V increment per row (16.16)
BLT_MODE7_TEX_W	0xF0070	Texture width mask (must be power-of-2 minus 1)
BLT_MODE7_TEX_H	0xF0074	Texture height mask (must be power-of-2 minus 1)

The rasteriser walks each destination pixel, computes the source UV from the affine matrix (origin + column delta + row delta), wraps via power-of-2 bitmask, and samples the source texture. This enables rotation, scaling, and perspective-like effects on tiled backgrounds - the same technique used by the SNES PPU2 for its Mode 7 background layer.

Video Compositor

The compositor collects immutable frame snapshots from all enabled video sources and blends them in Z-order (layer 0 at the back, layer 20 at the front). For IEVideoChip CLUT8 mode, both mapped VRAM and direct bus-backed VRAM are converted through the palette before compositing. Desktop startup uses a 1920x1080 fullscreen presentation by default, and the x64 live-image launcher locks it fullscreen through `IE_LIVE_IMAGE=1`. Native sources keep their requested dimensions. The default native mode is 960x540 for exact 2x 1080p presentation. Video compositor default scale mode is stretch-fill; F11 toggles non-16:9 sources to aspect-fit. Shift+F11 toggles fullscreen/windowed mode when that mode is not locked.

Two rendering paths:

1. **Scanline-aware path** - used when at least one enabled source implements `ScanLineAware`. The compositor advances scanline-capable sources in sorted layer order for each scanline, then blends all enabled sources in the global layer order. Opaque full-frame sources can sit below, between, or above scanline-aware sources without breaking copper/VGA per-scanline effects.
2. **Full-frame fallback** - used when no enabled source is scanline-aware. It collects complete frames and blends them in sorted layer order. Same-size frame blending uses parallel goroutines with 60-line strips via `sync.WaitGroup`.

All-zero frame pixels are transparent; any nonzero alpha or RGB value is opaque. During compositing, zero-alpha nonzero-RGB pixels are promoted to opaque 0xFFRRGGBB before they overwrite the destination. The compositor tick remains fixed at 60 Hz for guest VBlank compatibility; GetRefreshRate() reports the output backend rate, while GetTickRate() reports the compositor tick.

Triple-Buffer Protocol

All video systems except VideoChip use a lock-free triple-buffer protocol for GetFrame():

```
Slots:  writeIdx = 0 (producer-owned)
        sharedIdx = 1 (atomic, in-transit)
        readingIdx = 2 (consumer-owned)

Producer (render goroutine, after rendering into frameBufs[writeIdx]):
    writeIdx = sharedIdx.Swap(writeIdx)

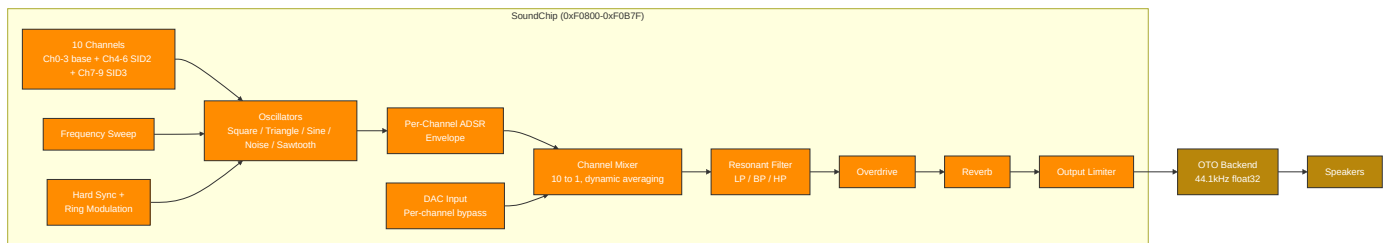
Consumer (compositor, GetFrame):
    readIdx = sharedIdx.Swap(readIdx)
    return frameBufs[readIdx]
```

Important: GetFrame() performs an atomic Swap - calling it twice in a row swaps back to the previous buffer. Always call once and save the result.

On resolution change, all 3 buffer slots are reallocated and indices reset to writeIdx=0, sharedIdx=1, readingIdx=2.

5. Audio Subsystem

Synthesis Pipeline



SoundChip Dual-Interface Architecture

The SoundChip exposes two register interfaces for its channels:

Legacy per-waveform interface (0xF0900-0xF09FF) - dedicated register blocks with two decoded sweep-register exceptions:

Decoded ranges: 0xF0900-0xF093F except 0xF0914 and 0xF0918, 0xF0940-0xF097F plus 0xF0914, and 0xF0980-0xF09BF plus 0xF0918.

Range	Channel	Default Waveform
0xF0900-0xF093F	Ch 0	Square, except 0xF0914 is triangle sweep and 0xF0918 is sine sweep
0xF0940-0xF097F plus 0xF0914	Ch 1	Triangle
0xF0980-0xF09BF plus 0xF0918	Ch 2	Sine

Range	Channel	Default Waveform
0xF09C0-0xF09FF	Ch 3	Noise
0xF0A00-0xF0A6F	-	Sawtooth + modulation/effects

Within the modulation/effects window, 0xF0A00-0xF0A1C holds the sync-source and ring-modulation-source registers, 0xF0A20-0xF0A6F holds the sawtooth legacy registers, and 0xF0A40, 0xF0A50, and 0xF0A54 hold overdrive and reverb controls.

FLEX unified interface (0xF0A80-0xF0B7F) - 4 channels with identical 64-byte register blocks. Each channel can be any waveform type:

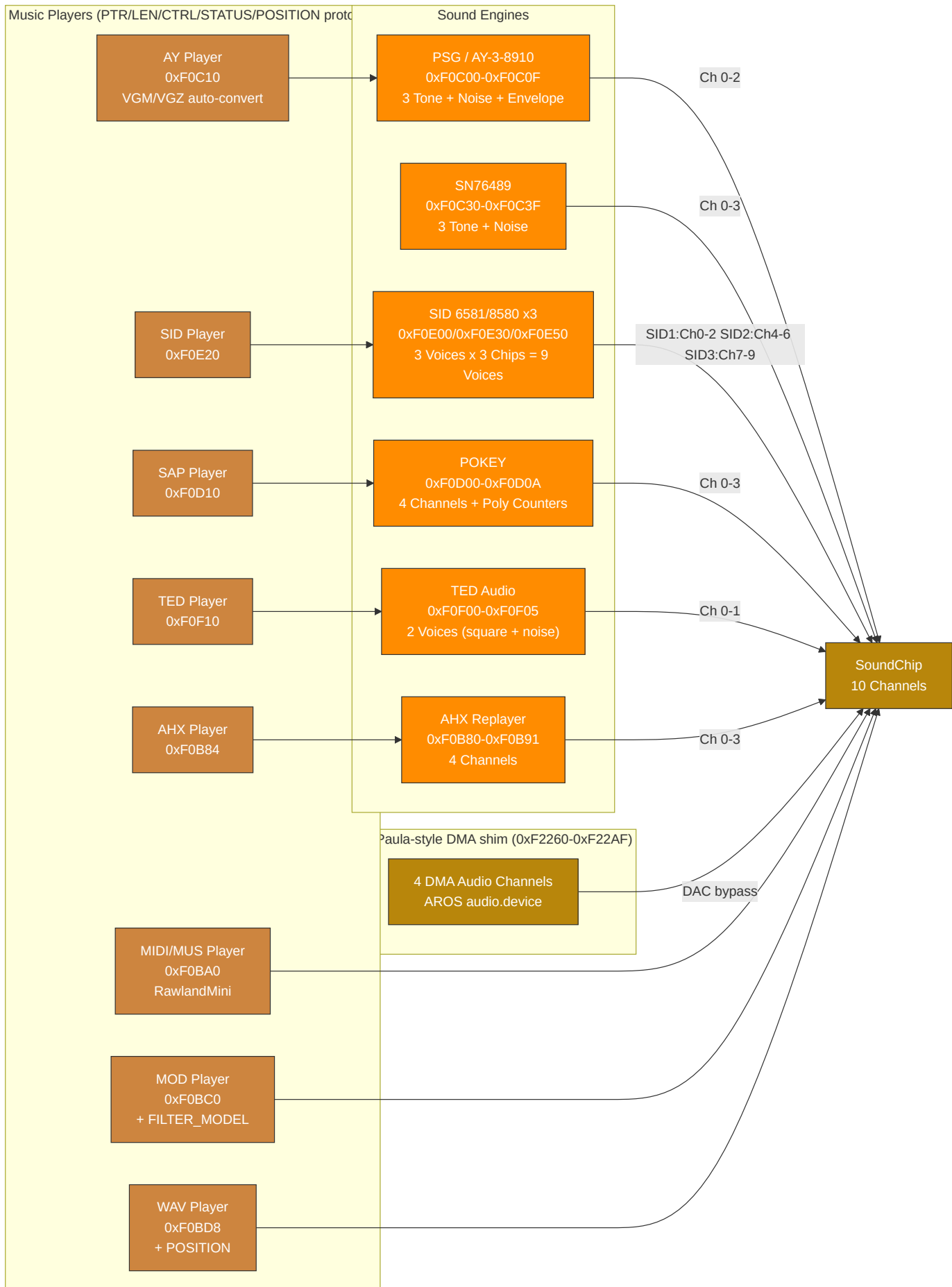
Offset	Register	Description
+0x00	FREQ	16.8 fixed-point Hz (value / 256.0)
+0x04	VOL	Volume (0-255)
+0x08	CTRL	Enable (bit 0), gate (bit 1)
+0x0C	DUTY	Pulse width duty cycle; high byte is PWM depth scaled by 1/256
+0x10	SWEEP	Frequency sweep rate
+0x14-0x20	ATK/DEC/SUS/REL	ADSR envelope
+0x24	WAVE_TYPE	Waveform selection
+0x28	PWM_CTRL	Pulse width modulation
+0x2C	NOISEMODE	Noise mode (0=white, 1=periodic, 2=metallic, 3=psg)
+0x30	PHASE	Phase reset
+0x34	RINGMOD	Ring modulation (bit 7=enable, 0-2=source)
+0x38	SYNC	Hard sync (bit 7=enable, 0-2=source)
+0x3C	DAC	DAC mode bypass (signed 8-bit sample, -128=-1.0, +127=+1.0)

FLEX channels are at FLEX_CH0_BASE = 0xF0A80, stride = 0x40. Primary channels 0-3 occupy 0xF0A80-0xF0B7F; SID2 flex channels 4-6 occupy 0xF0C40-0xF0CFF; SID3 flex channels 7-9 occupy 0xF0D40-0xF0DFF. AUDIO_CTRL uses bit 0 for enable and bit 1 for freeze. ENV_SHAPE remains at 0xF0804 for channel 0, with per-channel shapes at 0xF0860 + channel*4. Both legacy and FLEX interfaces write to the same underlying 10-channel mixer. The FLEX interface is preferred for new code - the legacy interface exists for backward compatibility.

Filter and Modulation

The SoundChip's global resonant filter (0xF0820-0xF0830) supports low-pass, band-pass, and high-pass modes with cutoff frequency, resonance, and optional filter modulation source/amount registers. Cutoff and resonance smooth toward register targets at the same 0.02 coefficient used by per-channel filters. SID 12-bit DAC quantization truncates to remove half-LSB DC bias.

Engine and Player Routing



Audio Engine Plus Enhanced Mode

All five classic-style sound engines have a "Plus" enhanced mode, activated by writing 1 to their respective PLUS_CTRL register:

Engine	PLUS_CTRL Address	Enhancements
PSG+	0xF0C20	Enhanced render path: oversampling, filtering, drive/room shaping, stereo voicing
SID+	0xF0E19	Enhanced render path for SID voices (oversampling/filter/drive/room shaping)
POKEY+	0xF0D09	Enhanced render path (oversampling/filter/drive/room shaping)
TED+	0xF0F05	Enhanced render path plus TED-specific response shaping
AHX+	0xF0B80	AHX voice-state mapping with stereo spread/panning and room processing

The PSG uses the AY/YM logarithmic 16-step volume curve by default. A legacy linear curve is retained for older material that depends on it.

When Plus mode is enabled, the engine retains full backward compatibility with the standard register set while exposing additional capabilities. AHX maps tracker state to native SoundChip channels instead of producing an AROS audio DMA stream; AHX+ uses a 64-sample crossfade when enabling/disabling to prevent audio glitches.

AROS Paula-Style DMA Shim ABI

The AROS audio block at 0xF2260-0xF22AF is an Intuition Engine shim for AROS `audio.device`, not a full Amiga Paula implementation.

- Guest code writes the shim with 32-bit aligned writes (`MOVE.L`). Narrower writes are outside the current ABI.
- A DMACON channel transition from 0 to 1 latches that channel's pointer, length, period, and volume. Active playback uses the latched values until the buffer ends.
- If the latched period or length is zero at arm time, the channel is not activated. The channel DMACON bit is cleared, the status bit is set, and a level-3 interrupt is raised when the corresponding INTENA bit is set.
- Buffer exhaust sets the status bit, raises a level-3 interrupt when the corresponding INTENA bit is set, marks the channel inactive, and clears that channel's DMACON bit. The guest must write DMACON enable again to start the next buffer.
- Out-of-range pointers beyond the active AROS profile RAM deactivate the channel, mute the DAC output, set the status bit, and raise a level-3 interrupt when the corresponding INTENA bit is set.
- Pointer writes ignore bit 0, length is a word count and preserves odd values, period writes with zero are ignored, and volume writes are clamped to 0..64.

Subsong Selection

SID, SAP, and AHX players support subsong selection for multi-tune files. Each player has a subsong register that selects which tune to play from a multi-song file.

SID PSID playback captures CIA1 timer-A latch writes at \$DC04/\$DC05; when non-zero, the player uses that latch as `cyclesPerTick`, so multispeed tunes run at `clockHz / latch`. SID MMIO opts into wide-write fanout: 16-bit and 32-bit writes are decomposed into little-endian byte register writes.

6. Memory Map

All CPU cores observe the same guest physical address space. Address ranges in this table are not per-core private maps unless explicitly stated. Some ranges have multiple architectural uses: for example, a decoded RAM range may also contain conventional worker buffers, framebuffer memory, or OS/profile-owned allocations. In those cases, the table describes reservations within the shared physical map, not separate mappings.

The Decoded as column describes how the bus routes a physical access. The Architectural use and Owner / lifetime columns describe the guest contract or current subsystem reservation inside that decoded mapping. Overlapping rows are intentional when a reservation lives inside a broader shared-RAM range.

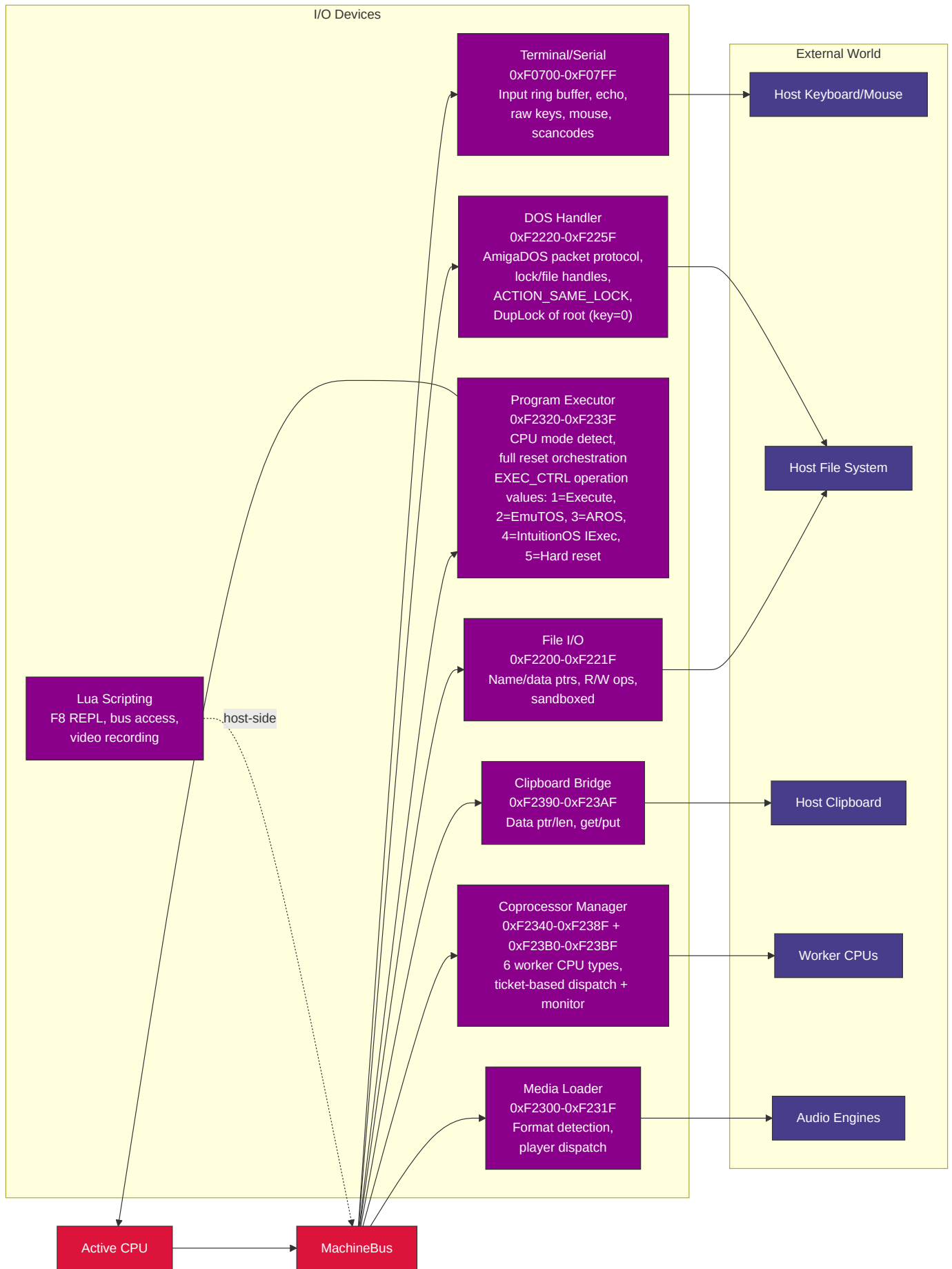
Range	Size	Decoded as	Architectural use	Visible to	Owner / lifetime	Notes
0x00000 - 0x9EFFF	636KB	Shared RAM	Main low-memory programme/data area	All CPU cores	Guest and boot-profile convention	Includes IE32 vector table base at 0x00000 and programme load convention at 0x01000.
0x9F000 - 0x9FFFF	4KB	Shared RAM	Default stack seed region	All CPU cores	CPU reset convention	IE32 and IE64 seed stack pointers at 0x9F000; it is still ordinary shared RAM.
0xA0000 - 0xAFFFF	64KB	VGA VRAM window	VGA graphics aperture	All CPU cores	VGA subsystem	x86 can also access this as conventional VGA graphics memory.
0xB8000 - 0xBFFFF	32KB	VGA text buffer	VGA text aperture	All CPU cores	VGA subsystem	Conventional text-memory range.
0xD0000 - 0xDFFFF	64KB	Voodoo texture memory	Voodoo texture upload/storage window	All CPU cores	Voodoo subsystem	Shared physical texture-memory aperture.
0xF0000 - 0xF049B	1180B	MMIO	VideoChip, copper, blitter, palette, and extended blitter registers	All CPU cores	Video subsystem	Layer-0 video control and DMA-style graphics operations.
0xF0700 - 0xF07FF	256B	MMIO	Terminal, serial, mouse, keyboard, and RTC_EPOCH (0xF0750)	All CPU cores	I/O subsystem	Input, terminal, and clock-facing low MMIO.
0xF0800 - 0xF0B7F	896B	MMIO	SoundChip channels, including FLEX	All CPU cores	Audio subsystem	Runtime audio-chip register block.
0xF0B80 - 0xF0B91	18B	MMIO	AHX engine/player	All CPU cores	Audio subsystem	Player-facing register block.
0xF0BA0 - 0xF0BBF	32B	MMIO	MIDI/MUS player	All CPU cores	Audio subsystem	Player-facing register block.
0xF0BC0 - 0xF0BD7	24B	MMIO	MOD player	All CPU cores	Audio subsystem	Player-facing register block.
0xF0BD8 - 0xF0BF3	28B	MMIO	WAV player	All CPU cores	Audio subsystem	Player-facing register block.

Range	Size	Decoded as	Architectural use	Visible to	Owner / lifetime	Notes
0xF0C00-0xF0C0F	16B	MMIO	PSG engine (AY-3-8910/YM2149 registers)	All CPU cores	Audio subsystem	Register-select/data-compatible PSG block.
0xF0C10-0xF0C1F	16B	MMIO	PSG / AY player	All CPU cores	Audio subsystem	Player-facing register block.
0xF0C20	1B	MMIO	PSG+ control	All CPU cores	Audio subsystem	Extended PSG control byte.
0xF0C30-0xF0C3F	16B	MMIO	Native SN76489 latch/data, ready, and LFSR mode registers	All CPU cores	Audio subsystem	Native SN76489-compatible control block.
0xF0C40-0xF0CFF	192B	MMIO	SID2 flex-style SoundChip channels 4-6	All CPU cores	Audio subsystem	Multi-SID/FLEX channel range.
0xF0D00-0xF0D0A	11B	MMIO	POKEY engine	All CPU cores	Audio subsystem	POKEY register block.
0xF0D10-0xF0D20	17B	MMIO	SAP player	All CPU cores	Audio subsystem	Player-facing register block.
0xF0D40-0xF0DFF	192B	MMIO	SID3 flex-style SoundChip channels 7-9	All CPU cores	Audio subsystem	Multi-SID/FLEX channel range.
0xF0E00-0xF0E1C	29B	MMIO	SID1 engine (6581/8580)	All CPU cores	Audio subsystem	Primary SID register block.
0xF0E20-0xF0E2D	14B	MMIO	SID player	All CPU cores	Audio subsystem	Player-facing register block.
0xF0E30-0xF0E4C	29B	MMIO	SID2 engine (6581/8580)	All CPU cores	Audio subsystem	Secondary SID register block.
0xF0E50-0xF0E6C	29B	MMIO	SID3 engine (6581/8580)	All CPU cores	Audio subsystem	Tertiary SID register block.
0xF0E80-0xF0EFF	128B	MMIO	SoundChip SFX trigger channels	All CPU cores	Audio subsystem	Trigger-oriented SFX range.
0xF0F00-0xF0F05	6B	MMIO	TED audio engine	All CPU cores	Audio subsystem	TED audio registers.
0xF0F10-0xF0F1F	16B	MMIO	TED player	All CPU cores	Audio subsystem	Player-facing register block.
0xF0F20-0xF0F6B	76B	MMIO	TED video	All CPU cores	TED video subsystem	Stride-4 TED video register mapping.
0xF3000-0xF6FFF	16KB	MMIO / TED VRAM aperture	TED private video RAM	All CPU cores	TED video subsystem	Bus-routed TED character, colour, and screen memory.
0xF1000-0xF13FF	1KB	MMIO	VGA registers	All CPU cores	VGA subsystem	Sequencer, CRTC, graphics-controller, attribute-controller, and DAC state.

Range	Size	Decoded as	Architectural use	Visible to	Owner / lifetime	Notes
0xF1400-0xF140F	16B	MMIO	Host helper	All CPU cores	Host-helper subsystem	Security-sensitive command helper gated by runtime configuration.
0xF2000-0xF2017	24B	MMIO	ULA registers	All CPU cores	ULA subsystem	Includes paged VRAM data port.
0xFA000-0xFBAFF	6912B	ULA VRAM aperture	ULA display memory	All CPU cores	ULA subsystem	Separate decoded aperture for ULA VRAM access.
0xF2100-0xF213F	64B	MMIO	ANTIC registers	All CPU cores	ANTIC subsystem	ANTIC display-list and DMA control block.
0xF2140-0xF21FB	188B	MMIO	GTIA registers	All CPU cores	GTIA subsystem	GTIA colour, player/missile, priority, and collision state.
0xF2200-0xF221F	32B	MMIO	File I/O	All CPU cores	File-I/O bridge	Host-file bridge register block.
0xF2220-0xF225F	64B	MMIO	AROS DOS handler	All CPU cores	AROS profile	AROS DOS integration register block.
0xF2260-0xF22AF	80B	MMIO	AROS Paula-style DMA shim	All CPU cores	AROS profile	Audio/DMA compatibility shim.
0xF2300-0xF231F	32B	MMIO	Media loader	All CPU cores	Media-loader subsystem	Format-agnostic media loading control block.
0xF2320-0xF233F	32B	MMIO	Program executor	All CPU cores	Program executor	CPU/program switching control block.
0xF2340-0xF238F	80B	MMIO	Coprocessor manager	All CPU cores	Coprocessor subsystem	Worker lifecycle, dispatch, and ticket registers.
0xF2390-0xF23AF	32B	MMIO	Clipboard bridge	All CPU cores	Clipboard bridge	Host clipboard integration register block.
0xF23B0-0xF23BF	16B	MMIO	Coprocessor extended monitor registers	All CPU cores	Coprocessor subsystem	Per-worker monitor/status extension.
0xF23C0-0xF23DF	32B	MMIO	AROS IRQ diagnostic registers	AROS M68K profile while AROS loader is active	AROS profile	Read-only diagnostic MMIO mapped by the AROS loader and unmapped during AROS DMA teardown; not a universal interrupt-controller ABI.
0xF23E0-0xF23FF	32B	MMIO	Bootstrap HostFS	All CPU cores	Bootstrap profile	HostFS boot helper register block.
0xF2400-0xF24FF	256B	MMIO	SYSINFO RAM-size discovery	All CPU cores	System information ABI	Reports total and active visible RAM.
0xF8000-0xF87FF	2KB	MMIO	Voodoo 3D registers and palette	All CPU cores	Voodoo subsystem	3D control, state, and palette register block.
0xF8140-0xF823F	256B	MMIO	Voodoo fog table	All CPU cores	Voodoo subsystem	64 entries x 4 bytes.

Range	Size	Decoded as	Architectural use	Visible to	Owner / lifetime	Notes
0x100000 - 0x5FFFFF	5MB	Shared RAM / VRAM-backed region	Main video framebuffer and graphics-visible memory	All CPU cores	Video subsystem plus guest convention	Subranges may be reserved for coprocessor worker buffers.
0x200000 - 0x27FFFF	512KB	Shared RAM	IE32 worker area	All CPU cores	Coprocessor convention	Lies inside the graphics-visible shared-memory range; not a separate address space.
0x280000 - 0x2FFFFF	512KB	Shared RAM	M68K worker area	All CPU cores	Coprocessor convention	Lies inside the graphics-visible shared-memory range; not a separate address space.
0x300000 - 0x30FFFF	64KB	Shared RAM	6502 worker area	All CPU cores	Coprocessor convention	Lies inside the graphics-visible shared-memory range; not a separate address space.
0x310000 - 0x31FFFF	64KB	Shared RAM	Z80 worker area	All CPU cores	Coprocessor convention	Lies inside the graphics-visible shared-memory range; not a separate address space.
0x320000 - 0x39FFFF	512KB	Shared RAM	x86 worker area	All CPU cores	Coprocessor convention	Lies inside the graphics-visible shared-memory range; not a separate address space.
0x3A0000 - 0x41FFFF	512KB	Shared RAM	IE64 worker area	All CPU cores	Coprocessor convention	Lies inside the graphics-visible shared-memory range; not a separate address space.
0x790000 - 0x7917FF	6KB	Shared RAM	Coprocessor mailbox ring buffers	All CPU cores	Coprocessor subsystem	Shared request/completion rings; outside the main graphics-visible range.
0x800000 - 0x80FFFF	64KB	Shared RAM	Media-loader staging buffer	All CPU cores	Media-loader subsystem	Reservation at the base of the AROS fast-memory range when that profile is active.
0x800000 - 0x1DFFFF	22MB	Shared RAM	AROS fast memory	All CPU cores	AROS profile	Profile-owned allocation range, not a distinct per-core map.
0x1E00000 - 0x5DFFFF	64MB	Shared RAM / video-profile memory	AROS video RAM	All CPU cores	AROS profile / video subsystem	Profile-owned video allocation range within shared physical memory.

7. I/O Peripherals



Coprocessor Worker Dispatch

The coprocessor manager supports 6 worker CPU types (IE32, IE64, 6502, M68K, Z80, x86) with ticket-based job dispatch and mailbox ring buffers at 0x790000. Each worker type has a dedicated shared-memory reservation in the unified physical map (see memory map above), not a private per-core address space. The main CPU enqueues work via MMIO writes; workers execute independently and post results back through their mailbox slots. Each ring has 16 descriptor slots but uses one slot to distinguish full from empty, so it can hold 15 queued requests at once. When COPROC_IRQ_CTRL bit 0 is set and an M68K IRQ target plus completion watcher have been configured, the coprocessor asserts M68K interrupt level 6 on job completion, with the finished ticket ID readable from COPROC_COMPLETED_TICKET. Non-M68K modes should observe completion through POLL or WAIT.

Lua Scripting

The Lua scripting engine (`script_engine.go`) runs in its own goroutine and provides host-side automation over the shared 32-bit bus/MMIO surface plus CPU-adapter debugger APIs. Its `mem.*` helpers are raw 32-bit bus helpers, not an above-4GiB IE64 RAM or CPU-virtual-address API. It supports an F8 REPL for interactive debugging, video recording, and direct chip register manipulation. Scripts use the `.ies` extension and are loaded via the IE Script Engine.

IEMon Reverse-Debug Snapshot Contract

IEMon whole-machine snapshots enumerate the monitor CPU registry by stable CPU id and label, so profiles with omitted CPUs or multiple coprocessors restore by identity rather than by CPU type. Shared bus RAM and IE64 backing memory are stored as sparse 4 KiB pages. The reverse-history chain keeps full sparse checkpoints plus page deltas anchored to retained checkpoints; the monitor materialises deltas before `rg` or `rt` applies a restore.

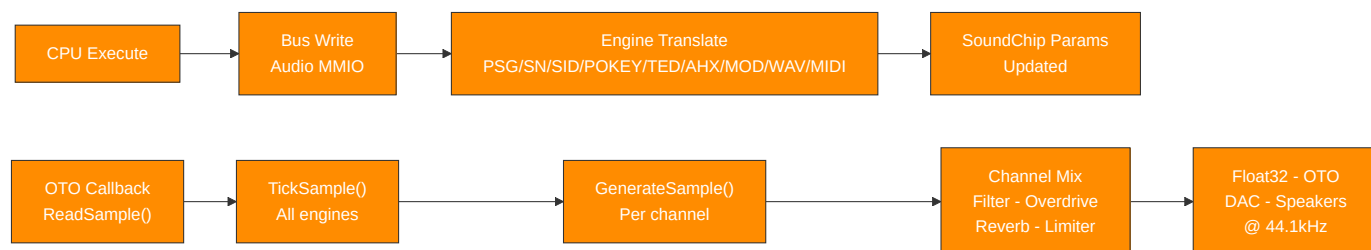
Mutable devices join the snapshot contract through `MachineMonitor.RegisterSnapshotDevice`. Each device supplies a stable name, a version, and an opaque guest-visible state blob. Restore fails closed if a captured device is absent, preventing partial reverse-debug restores. The production monitor registers the main video chip, sound chip, terminal MMIO, command-style host helpers, compatibility audio/video engines, and AROS clipboard/audio-DMA bridges when present; new guest-visible timers, DMA engines, IRQ controllers, and host bridges must register their own versioned blobs before they are considered covered by whole-machine reverse debugging.

8. Data Flow

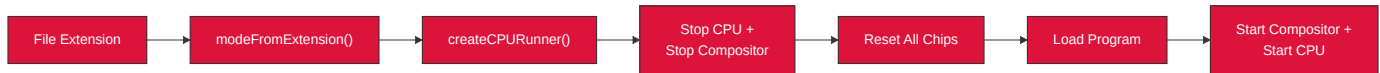
Video Pipeline



Audio Pipeline



CPU Mode Switching



9. Concurrency Model and System Timing

Goroutine Inventory

Goroutine	Clock Source	Rate	Synchronisation
CPU execution	Free-running for <code>running.Load()</code> loop	As fast as Go scheduler allows	MMIO writes invoke I/O callbacks under per-chip <code>mu</code>
VideoChip refresh	<code>time.NewTicker</code>	60Hz	Copper + blitter + dirty-tile copy + buffer swap
VGA render	<code>time.NewTicker</code>	60Hz	Renders into triple-buffer slot, publishes via <code>sharedIdx.Swap()</code>
ULA render	<code>time.NewTicker</code>	60Hz	Same triple-buffer pattern
TED render	<code>time.NewTicker</code>	60Hz	Same triple-buffer pattern
ANTIC render	<code>time.NewTicker</code>	60Hz	Same triple-buffer pattern
Compositor	<code>time.NewTicker</code>	60Hz	Calls <code>GetFrame()</code> (atomic swap) on each source, blends, sends to display
OTO audio thread	Host audio hardware callback	44.1kHz	Calls <code>SoundChip.ReadSample()</code> -> <code>GenerateSample()</code> directly
Terminal output	<code>time.NewTicker</code>	100Hz	Flushes output buffer to host terminal
Coprocessor workers	On-demand	Varies	Independent CPUs with mailbox ring buffers
Script engine	Event-driven	Varies	Lua goroutine with frame-sync channel

Three Independent Clocks

CPU: Free-running (no fixed clock -- instruction throughput varies with host speed)
Video: 6 video sources plus compositor tick at 60Hz; non-VideoChip sources use lock-free triple-buffer handoff
Audio: OTO hardware callback drives sample generation at 44.1kHz -- no IE-owned goroutine

Synchronisation Model

Hot paths (lock-free): - `atomic.Bool` - CPU running, chip enabled, `compositorManaged` - `atomic.Int32` - triple-buffer `sharedIdx` - `atomic.Pointer` - selected CPU pointer

Cold paths (mutex-protected): - `sync.Mutex` (`chip.mu`, `video.mu`) - configuration changes, setup, stop

CPU-to-Video: - CPU writes to VRAM/MMIO invoke I/O callbacks under per-chip `mu` - Video chips read VRAM lock-free (snapshot-render pattern: copy under lock, render without lock)

CPU-to-Audio: - CPU writes to audio MMIO update channel parameters under `chip.mu` - OTO callback reads parameters atomically or under `chip.mu` for `GenerateSample()`

No CPU-video vsync coupling: - CPU runs ahead freely - no wait-for-vblank blocking - WAIT register polls vblankActive atomic.Bool without blocking the CPU

Appendix: Key Source Files

File	Role
registers.go	Master I/O address map - all region boundaries
machine_bus.go	MachineBus: autodetected guest RAM, MapIO, ioPageBitmap, Read/Write, SYSINFO accessors
memory_sizing.go	Boot-time guest RAM autodetection: total guest RAM + active visible RAM with platform reserves
profile_bounds.go	Source-owned profile bounds for EmuTOS, AROS, IE64 BASIC
emulator_cpu.go	EmulatorCPU interface definition
video_interface.go	VideoSource, VideoOutput, ScanlineAware interfaces
video_compositor.go	Compositor pipeline, Z-order blending
video_chip.go	VideoChip + Copper + Blitter + Palette
video_vga.go	VGA engine (Sequencer, CRTC, GC, AC, DAC)
video_ula.go	ULA engine (Spectrum display)
video_ted.go	TED video engine
video_antic.go	ANTIC + GTIA engines
video_voodoo.go	Voodoo 3D pipeline
audio_chip.go	SoundChip (10-channel synthesis)
psg_engine.go	PSG / AY-3-8910
sn76489_chip.go	SN76489 programmable sound generator
sid_engine.go	SID 6581/8580
pokey_engine.go	POKEY
ted_engine.go	TED audio
ahx_engine.go	AHX replayer
mod_player.go	MOD player
wav_player.go	WAV player
midi_player.go / midi_engine.go / midi_parser.go	SMF .mid/.midi and Doom .mus; fixed RawlandMini IE SoundChip GM-style/chiptune interpretation, 10 active MIDI voices with deterministic stealing
cpu_ie32.go	IE32 CPU
cpu_ie64.go	IE64 CPU + interpreter
fpu_ie64.go	IE64 FPU (16 x float32)
jit_emit_arm64.go	IE64 JIT ARM64 emitter
jit_emit_amd64.go	IE64 JIT x86-64 emitter

File	Role
cpu_m68k.go	M68K 68020
fpu_m68881.go	M68881 FPU (8 x float64)
cpu_z80.go	Z80
cpu_z80_runner.go	Z80 bus adapter, port I/O bridge, bank windows
cpu_six5go2.go	6502 + bus adapter, ioTable dispatch, bank windows
cpu_x86.go	x86
cpu_x86_runner.go	x86 bus adapter, shared port I/O bridge, bank windows, and VGA VRAM window
fpu_x87.go	x87 FPU (8 x float64 stack)
terminal_io.go	Terminal / Serial / Mouse / Keyboard
file_io.go	File I/O
program_executor.go	Program Executor
coprocessor_manager.go	Coprocessor Manager
clipboard_bridge.go	Clipboard Bridge
media_loader.go	Media format detection + player dispatch
script_engine.go	Lua scripting engine
aros_loader.go	AROS ROM boot manager
aros_dos_intercept.go	AmigaDOS packet handler (MMIO)
aros_audio_dma.go	AROS Paula-style DMA shim